A PLAIN-LANGUAGE GUIDE

Pappilon

Notice a place. Mark it. Let it help others.

A friendly, step-by-step guide to using the Pappilon app to record how everyday public transport places feel, even if you have never used a mapping app before.

Screenshot placeholder

Phone screen: the Pappilon map
Suggested size 236 x 440 px

Mapping the Gendered Experience of Women Commuters in Indian Public Transportation Spaces

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WELCOME

Hello, and welcome to Pappilon

The name comes from *papillon*, the French word for butterfly. A butterfly lands on one flower after another: it pauses, takes in what is there, and moves on. Pappilon asks you to do something similar as you travel. Pause at a place, notice how it feels, and leave a small mark. Many small marks from many people become a picture that researchers can learn from.

What the app is, in plain words

- A **map** where you add the places you travel through or wait at.
- A **picture** of each place that you can put small markers on, called pins.
- A quick **rating and note** for each marker, saved safely to your account.

Who it is for

- Women who use buses, metro or local trains in India.
- Anyone, even if you have never used a mapping app. Every step is explained.
- You choose how many places to record and when to stop.

Four promises about your privacy

Username only

No email address or real name is needed to take part.

Anonymous

Observations are anonymised. Do not record personal details.

500 m rule

Do not record places within 500 metres of your home or workplace.

Your choice

Taking part is voluntary. You can stop at any time.

Illustration or photo placeholder

For example: a woman pausing at a bus stop with her phone
Suggested size 686 x 168 px

How to read this guide

TIP Yellow boxes are small helpful hints that save you time.

HEADS-UP Orange boxes warn you about something to be careful with.

PLAIN WORDS Lilac boxes explain a word or idea in everyday language. Blue dashed boxes mark where a screenshot belongs.

THE BIG PICTURE

The life of one place

Every place you record goes through the same five short stages, a little like the life cycle of a butterfly. There is no hurry and no wrong order to worry about. Your work is saved as you go, so you can stop and come back later.



1

Add

Put a place on the map: tap it, or use your location.

Page 6



2

Look

Open a picture of the place, such as Street View or a train interior.

Page 7



3

Pin

Drop pins on what you notice and say a little about each.

Pages 8 and 9



4

Settle

Give your overall feeling and mark the place as done.

Page 10



5

Send off

When you are finished, export your work and share it.

Page 10

Screenshot placeholder

A finished place: map marker, list entry and pins on the picture
Suggested size 686 x 150 px

Words you will see

Place One spot you record, such as a bus stop, a platform or the inside of a train. The app also calls it a point.

Session A named notebook for one outing, like "Mumbai walk 01". Everything you record goes into it.

Pin A small round marker you put on the picture to show exactly what you mean.

Icon A little symbol that says what a pin is about, such as light, seating or staring.

Lens A group of icons that look at a place in one way. There are three lenses.

Score A number from 1 (very unsafe) to 5 (very safe) for the thing you pinned.

Tag A ready-made short label, such as "Busy" or "Dark patch", that you tap to add detail.

Note Your own words about what you saw or how it felt.

Gut check Your overall feeling about the whole place, from 1 to 5, given at the end.

360° picture A picture you can turn around in, as if you were standing there. Street View is one.

Sync The app saving your work to your account online. The top bar says "Saved".

Export Packing your pictures and pins into one file to share.

TIP You do not need to learn these words now. Each one is explained again where it first matters.

GETTING STARTED

Five steps to your first place

You only do steps 1 to 4 once. After that, opening the app takes you straight to your map.

1 Put the app on your phone

Open the Pappilon website in **Chrome** itself, not inside WhatsApp. Tap the **three dots** at the top right, then tap **Install app** (or **Add to Home screen**). A Pappilon icon appears with your other apps. If you see an **Install app** button at the top of the screen, you can tap that instead.

Screenshot placeholder
Chrome menu with Install app
190 x 112 px

2 Create your account

Tap **Create account**. Choose a **User ID** (3 to 24 letters or numbers; dots, dashes and underscores are fine) and a **password** of at least 6 characters. Type the password again, then tap **Create my account**. No email is needed.

Screenshot placeholder
Create account screen
190 x 112 px

3 Read and sign the consent form

The first time only, a consent form appears. Read the information sheet to the end, tap **I have read this**, tick the four boxes, then tap **Sign and submit**. Your username and today's date become your signature.

Screenshot placeholder
Consent screen with four boxes
190 x 112 px

4 Name your session

A session is a notebook for one outing. Type a name such as **Mumbai walk 01** and tap **Start fieldwork**. You can start more sessions later.

Screenshot placeholder
Session name screen
190 x 112 px

5 Say yes to location, if asked

The map opens. If your phone asks to use your location, tap **Allow**. This lets the **REPORT** button find where you are. You can add places without it by tapping the map.

Screenshot placeholder
The main map screen
190 x 112 px

TIP If you forget your password, ask your project coordinator to reset it. Write your User ID somewhere safe, because there is no email to recover it.

SCREEN TOUR

Know your screen

The app has three parts. On a phone you see one part at a time and switch with the three buttons at the bottom. On a computer all three sit side by side.

Screenshot placeholder
Points tab
210 x 280 px

Screenshot placeholder
Image tab
210 x 280 px

Screenshot placeholder
Tag tab
210 x 280 px

1 Points

Your map and list of places. Each place is a dot: grey means to do, yellow means started, and a colour from red to green means finished. The round **REPORT** button adds a place where you are standing. Below is a list you can search.

2 Image

The picture of the place you picked. Buttons above it choose the picture: Street View, your own image, or a standard bus, metro or local train interior. Tap anywhere on the picture to drop a pin.

3 Tag

Where you describe each pin. Pick a lens and an icon, give a score, add tags and a note. At the bottom is your overall **gut check** and the **Complete point** button.

The bar at the top

Screenshot placeholder
The top bar with progress ring, level and buttons. Suggested size 686 x 84 px

- **Progress ring:** how many of your places are finished.
- **Level bar:** a friendly reward that grows as you record more.
- **Saved chip:** says Saved, Saving, or Offline. Offline work is sent later.
- **Reminder and Account:** your daily nudge, and switching session or signing out.
- **Insights:** a summary of the places that scored lowest.
- **Finish and export:** packs your work to share. The question mark opens help.

STAGE 1 · ADD

Add a place to your map

A place is one spot you want to describe, such as a bus stop, a station entrance or the inside of a coach. There are three ways to add one. Most people only need the first two.

WAY 1

Tap the map

1. Zoom in to the exact spot. Pinch with two fingers, or use the plus and minus buttons.
2. Tap once on the map. A new dot appears, named **Place 1**, **Place 2** and so on.
3. If the dot is a little off, press and drag it to the right spot.

Every tap on the map adds a place, so tap only when you mean to.

Screenshot placeholder

Tapping the map: a new dot appears
Suggested size 190 x 262 px

WAY 2

Use the round REPORT button

1. Stand where you want to record. Tap **REPORT, Current Location**.
2. If your phone asks, tap **Allow** so the app can find you.
3. A place called **My location** appears at your position and the map moves there.

Screenshot placeholder

The round REPORT button
Suggested size 190 x 196 px

WAY 3 · OPTIONAL

Bring in a list of places

If your project coordinator gave you a spreadsheet file of places (a CSV file), tap **+ CSV** on the map and choose it. The places load all at once. You do not need this to take part.

HEADS-UP Do not add places within 500 m of your home or workplace.

Looking after your places

- **Pick a place:** tap its dot on the map or its row in the list. The arrows above the picture jump to the previous or next place.
- **See them all:** tap the small corner button on the map to zoom out so every dot fits.
- **Find one:** type in the search box, or switch the list between All, To do and Done.
- **Move one:** press and drag its dot on the map. The new position is saved.
- **Delete one:** touch and hold its row in the list (or right-click on a computer), then confirm. Its pins and ratings go too.

HEADS-UP Deleting a place cannot be undone. If you are unsure, leave it and just do not complete it.

STAGE 2 · LOOK

Choose a picture to work on

Your pins sit on a picture of the place, so each place needs one. When you open a place that has no picture yet, the app tries to find one for you. You can also pick one yourself.

STREET VIEW

Automatic street photo

For a place on a street, the app asks Google for the nearest Street View photo within about 120 metres and shows it as a picture you can turn around in. You need an internet connection. If nothing is found, tap **Search 400 m** or choose another picture.

INSIDE A VEHICLE

Standard interior

To record inside a vehicle, tap **Bus**, **Metro** or **Local train** under "Standard transit interior". The app loads a reference picture of that kind of vehicle. If the place already has a picture, it asks before replacing it.

YOUR OWN

Your own image

Tap **Own image** and choose a photo or panorama from your phone. The camera button is switched off in this study, so take the photo with your phone's camera first, then pick it here.

LOOK AROUND

Open in Maps

Tap **Maps** to open Google Street View in a new tab. It is useful for exploring a spot yourself. Pins are still added on the picture inside Pappilon.

Screenshot placeholder

A 360° Street View picture with the picture buttons above
Suggested size 335 x 150 px

Screenshot placeholder

A standard bus interior picture
Suggested size 335 x 150 px

Moving around the picture

- **Look around:** drag the picture with one finger. Pinch to zoom in and out.
- **Flat or 360:** the button in the top row switches between a flat picture and the turn-around view.
- **Full screen:** use the expand button on the picture for a bigger view.
- **Where pictures live:** pictures stay on your phone. On a new device, load the picture again. Your pins are safe in your account.

HEADS-UP Do not use photos that show people's faces or anything that identifies someone, and nothing taken within 500 m of your home or workplace.

STAGE 3 · PIN

Pin what you notice

This is the heart of the app. A pin is a small round marker you place on the picture, then describe. Add as many pins as you like, one for each thing you notice.

1. **Choose a lens**
   Open the **Tag** tab. Three buttons at the top are lenses, which are different ways of looking: harassment, street conditions, and how people behave and respond.

2. **Pick an icon**
   Tap the icon for what you want to describe, such as **Light** or **Staring**. On a computer, hover over an icon to read a short explanation. Page 9 lists them all.

3. **Tap the picture**
   A round pin lands where you tap. A dashed ring means you have not rated it yet.

4. **Give it a score**
   Tap one of five faces to say how safe that thing makes the place feel.

   1 Very unsafe | 2 Unsafe | 3 Mixed | 4 Safe | 5 Very safe

5. **Add tags and a note**
   Tap any tags that fit, or type your own in the **+ tag** box. Then write a note in your own words, such as "shutters down after 7pm, nowhere to sit".

6. **Tap "Done with this pin"**
   Your pin is saved. Tap the picture again to add the next one.

Screenshot placeholder
A picture with several pins and the Tag tab beside it
Suggested size 220 x 352 px

Screenshot placeholder
The five score faces and tags
Suggested size 220 x 196 px

Fix or remove a pin

- Move it: press and drag the pin on the picture.
- Change it: tap the pin, then pick a different icon or score.
- Delete it: tap the pin, then the bin button.

When no icon fits

Choose **Other, describe it** and write what is happening in your own words. No score is needed for this one. In the third lens, **Interpretation** works the same way.

PLAIN WORDS **Observe first.** Describe what you can see or hear before guessing why someone acted that way. Mark any guess as your interpretation.

REFERENCE

The three lenses and their icons

A lens is a way of looking at a place. Each lens has its own set of icons. Use whichever icon matches what you notice. You can switch lenses at any time, even for pins on the same picture.

LENS 1
Harassment and unwanted attention

Unwanted behaviour towards women and girls.

- Staring or watching
- Catcalling or comments
- Sexual gestures
- Following or trailing
- Blocking or trapping
- Unwanted closeness
- Unwanted touching
- Unwanted photographing
- Sexual exposure
- Threat or intimidation
- Sexual or physical assault
- Repeated harassment
- Response or help
- Effect on movement
- Other, describe it

LENS 2
Street conditions

The surroundings that can make a place feel safer or less safe.

- Places to stay
- People around
- See and be seen
- Light
- Easy to move
- Ways out and help
- Clean and cared for
- Feel welcome
- Useful facilities
- Active edges (shops, vendors)
- Comfort and pleasure
- Other, describe it

LENS 3
Human behaviour and social response

What people nearby do and say. Record what is visible, not guesses about why.

- Peer or group response
- Bystander response
- Target response or impact
- Accountability or deterrence
- Social cues and norms
- Situation or opportunity
- Interaction sequence
- Interpretation, describe it

A worked example

1. You walk through a dim underpass. Open **Street conditions**.
2. Tap the **Light** icon, then tap the dark spot on the picture.
3. Score it **2, Unsafe**. Tag it **Dark patch** and **Broken light**.
4. Note: "Two lamps are out, I walked faster here."

Screenshot placeholder

The three lens buttons and icon grid in the Tag tab
Suggested size 300 x 160 px

PLAIN WORDS You do not have to use every icon. Pick only the ones that match what you actually noticed.

STAGES 4 AND 5 · SETTLE AND SEND OFF

Finish a place, then send it off

When you have pinned what you want to say about a place, you close it with one last question. When your outing is over, you pack everything up to share.

Settle: finish the place

1. **Do the gut check**
   At the bottom of the Tag tab, tap the face that matches how safe the **whole place** feels, from 1 (very unsafe) to 5 (very safe).
2. **Tap "Complete point and next"**
   The place turns into a finished dot on the map, you earn points, and the app takes you to your next unfinished place.
3. **Changed your mind?**
   Open the place and tap **Reopen this point**. You can then add pins or change ratings.

Screenshot placeholder
Gut check faces and the Complete button
Suggested size 262 x 196 px

Levels and Insights

Pins, tags, notes and finished places earn points that move you up the levels in the top bar. It is only a friendly encouragement.

Curious Walker · Street Scout · Sightline Sleuth · Lantern Bearer · City Cartographer · Right-to-Loiter Legend

The **Insights** button shows which themes you rated lowest, the tags you used most, and the places that felt least safe to you.

Send off: export your work

1. Tap **Finish and export** in the top bar.
2. Tap **Build my .zip**. The app draws your pins onto each picture and packs a zip file with the annotated pictures, a list of every pin and a list of every place.
3. Choose how to share: **Share** (WhatsApp, email and more on a phone), **Download**, **Email**, **WhatsApp**, or a **private link** that works for 7 days.
4. Send it to whoever your project coordinator told you to.

Screenshot placeholder
The Finish and export window with share buttons
Suggested size 262 x 238 px

HEADS-UP Pictures stay on the phone where you loaded them. Export on that same phone, or places whose pictures are missing will be left out.

GOOD HABITS

Reminders, safety and privacy

A small daily nudge can help you remember to record. Just as important, here is how to keep yourself and your privacy safe while you take part.

Set a daily reminder

1. Tap the bell button, **Reminder**, in the top bar.
2. Choose the time you would like to be reminded.
3. Tap **Turn on reminder**. If your phone asks about notifications, tap **Allow**.
4. Tap **Send test** to check it works. Turn it off any time from the same window.

If you have not recorded anything that day (a place, a pin, a rating or a finished place), you get a nudge after your chosen time, and a prompt when you open the app. Once you record something, it stays quiet until tomorrow.

Screenshot placeholder

The Daily reminder window
Suggested size 250 x 236 px

HEADS-UP Reminders work best when Pappilon is installed on your phone. If the app has been closed for a long time, Android may delay or skip one. If notifications are blocked, allow them in Chrome's site settings.

Staying safe and private

Your safety comes first

Use the app only when it is safe to. Stop walking or step aside before you record. If you feel unsafe, put the phone away.

The 500 m rule

Do not record places within 500 metres of your home or workplace.

No identifying details

Do not write names, phone numbers or number plates, and do not use photos that show faces.

Record only what is safe to document

For serious incidents, note only what is appropriate and safe. You never have to describe more than you want to.

It is your choice

Taking part is voluntary. You can stop at any time without any consequences.

Not an emergency tool

Pappilon does not alert anyone. In an emergency call **112**. Women's helpline: **181**. Railway helpline: **139**.

QUESTIONS? Principal Investigator Gautam Parwar: gautam.parwar@iitb.ac.in, +91 9823093980. Ethics board (IIT Bombay IRB): irb@ircc.iitb.ac.in.

HELP

When something does not go to plan

Most problems have a quick fix. Find your question below. The question-mark button in the top bar also opens a short built-in help.

I forgot my password.
Ask your project coordinator to reset it. There is no email recovery, so keep your User ID somewhere safe.

The top bar says "Offline, will retry".
Your phone has no internet right now. Keep working. The app sends everything when the connection returns.

The picture is missing on a new phone.
Pictures stay on the phone where you loaded them. Open the place and load the picture again. Your pins are safe in your account.

It says "No Street View within 120 m".
Tap **Search 400 m**, or choose a standard bus, metro or train interior, or one of your own images.

Nothing happens when I tap the picture.
Wait for the picture to finish loading and make sure a place is selected in the list.

The REPORT button cannot find me.
Allow location when your phone asks. If you said no before, allow it in Chrome's site settings, and make sure your phone's location is switched on.

I cannot install the app.
Open the link in Chrome itself, not inside another app. Reload the page once, then use the three-dot menu and tap **Install app**.

I added a place by mistake.
Touch and hold its row in the list, then confirm Delete.

I dropped a pin by accident.
Tap the pin, then tap the bin button. On a computer you can also press Del.

Where is my work?
"Saved" in the top bar means it is in your account. On another device, log in with the same User ID and open the same session name.

Keyboard shortcuts (computer)

1 to 5	Give the selected pin a score
Del	Delete the selected pin
Esc	Deselect the pin
N P	Next or previous place
D	Complete or reopen the place

Screenshot placeholder
The built-in Help window
Suggested size 300 x 150 px

STILL STUCK? Write to your project coordinator, or to Gautam Parwar at gautam.parwar@iitb.ac.in. Tell them what you tapped and what you saw on the screen.

PUBLIC DOMAIN

Licence and credits

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To the extent possible under law, COPYRIGHT HOLDER has waived all copyright and related rights to Pappilon. Source code: REPOSITORY URL. SPDX identifier: **CC0-1.0**.

In plain words, you are free to

1. **Use it** for any purpose, including research or commercial work.
2. **Study it.** The full source code is available to everyone.
3. **Share it.** Pass copies to others, free or for a fee.
4. **Change it** and keep your changes private or share them.

What you must do

Nothing is required for Pappilon itself. Other software it uses has its own licences, listed below, and those may ask you to keep their notices. Please also keep real participant data safe and follow your own ethics approval.

What it does not cover

CC0 covers the software and documentation. It gives no right to the data participants record, which the consent form protects. It grants no patent or trademark rights, and there is no warranty.

Credits to other software

COMPONENT	USED FOR	LICENCE
Leaflet	The map	BSD 2-Clause
Photo Sphere Viewer	360 and flat picture viewing	MIT
PapaParse	Reading and writing CSV lists	MIT
JSZip	Packing the export zip file	MIT or GPL v3
Supabase	Accounts and storage of records	Hosted service, its own terms
CARTO basemap	Map background	© OpenStreetMap contributors, © CARTO
Google Street View	Street-level pictures	Google's terms of service

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